

Ubuntu 14.04 released for the desktop

Canonical has just released the Ubuntu 14.04 Long Term Support (LTS) desktop edition. The company had earlier unveiled Ubuntu 14.04 LTS edition for servers. However, its arrival on the desktop comes as a relief for all those looking to replace the Windows XP.

Ubuntu's latest release for the desktop brings a slew of performance improvements. In the words of sources at Canonical, "Users will notice a slicker experience, with improvements to Unity (the user interface). The release also includes all the tools required for business use, including remote delivery of applications, compatibility with Windows file formats, browser-based cloud solutions and the Microsoft Office compatible Libreoffice suite." You now get the option to use Unity 8, which is also the UI used on mobile versions of the OS—a major step forward in what Canonical terms 'complete convergence'. Further, the Ubuntu app store is expected to have a slew of converged apps that will give developers the freedom to write apps just once and make them usable on a string of devices and screen sizes.

Users will also be able to choose whether or not they want application menus to appear globally or locally. Canonical has now come up with a replacement for the much-criticised global menu bar.

Microsoft Office arrives on Chrome Web Store

First, Microsoft decided to capitalise on the success of the Android platform by offering the free Office Mobile app for it and also releasing an open source SDK for Office 365. Now, the Redmond giant has revealed that it's not averse to supporting the Chromebook (that it earlier gave the thumbs down to). Microsoft Office has now officially arrived on the Chrome Web Store along with a slew of handy new features.

Users can now launch most of Office's Web apps in the Chrome browser itself or on the Chrome OS just by clicking on an available short cut. OneNote Online now comes with printing support, while Excel will now let you add comments. Similarly, PowerPoint will now let you accurately preview texts while Word will let you add footnotes and lists much more easily and efficiently.



Finally, an entirely open source laptop



Two computer enthusiasts, Sean Cross and Bunnie Huang, have developed a laptop entirely out of open source hardware equipment. They say that they wanted to learn something new, while making devices we would actually use on a daily basis.

According to reports, the open source laptop has been dubbed as Project Novena. It is a home-made laptop of sorts with open source hardware, the specs for which are freely available to everyone.

The duo has structured a case that has many components, which can be printed from a 3D printer. They have used open source Das U-Boot, rather than the proprietary firmware.

CyanogenMod 11.0 M5 is now available for more than 50 devices



CyanogenMod has launched the successor to its M4 ROM for the Android 4.4 KitKat OS. The latest Snapshot build for the CM 11.0 has been rolled out for more than 50 smart devices that are powered by the latest KitKat OS.

The new update is available in CyanogenMod's portal and the company's updater. The new CyanogenMod 11.0 M5 build comes with many changes compared to the last M4 build.

